assigned the task of visiting three camps—Beaune-la-Rolande, Jargeau and Pithiviers—on the outskirts of Orléans to obtain the signatures of the men sent there from Paris. He'd done as the Parisian notary asked, but in speaking to the men, discovered they were doctors, dentists, professors, and some had even fought for France, like her father, in the Great War.

Léa remembered the afternoon he returned, sitting in silence, staring out the window. She'd asked what crimes they were being held for, and he shook his head in bewilderment. "They themselves do not know, only that they are all Jewish, though most do not practice or attend synagogue." He'd straightened his back and looked her in the eye. "I will try to help them. I'm afraid my profession is actively stripping these men of their property and if I cannot stop it then at least I will play no part in it."

She'd typed the letter he'd written back to the Parisian notary. The Association of Notaries responded a week later, warning he would never work again, but Maître Mallon held his ground. "If I refuse, maybe it will give others the courage to do the same."

A year later, all his clients had switched their business to other notaries. Now, Maître Mallon had no choice but to close his office.

It was likely the last time she would see him. She wanted to part on a hopeful note. "Perhaps I can make more shirts for the men. Winter is coming and they will need extra layers." With the old sheets from the hotel laundries, she and Rose had made shirts to get the men through the winter.

He shook his head. "Thank you, but they're no longer needed."

She leaned forward, not understanding what he meant.

"The men have gone."

Surely they'd returned home to their families in Paris? She smiled at the possibility that his stance had helped them. He must have read her thoughts as his eyes, solemn and sullen, locked on hers. "Over the summer, they were shipped by train to Poland."

"Poland?" Her heart sank. She couldn't imagine what they would do there, and if their clothes hadn't been sufficient for the winters in Orléans, how would they manage farther north in Poland?

"I'm afraid that's not all," he continued. "They filled the empty camps with their wives and children."

A shiver ran through Léa. What sort of sick person could come up with such a plan? Separating families, sending the men away first, then interning